The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen

Course Outline

2025-26 Term 2

1. Course identity

A. Course as listed at CUHK-Shenzhen

The information in this block should be exactly as approved by CUHK Senate. In case there are any differences, please explain in the table below.

Course code	DDA2082
Course title (English)	Independent Study II
Course title (Chinese)	独立学习(二)
Units	2
Description (English)	The registered SDS students are required to carry out independent study on a selected topic. Each one is expected to meet with the supervisor weekly, write written reports on their studies (either an experimental study, or a study of assigned books/papers), and will make a final public presentation. The grading will be based on the reports and presentation.
Description (Chinese)	注册本课程的 SDS 学生必须就选定的主题进行独立学习。每个人都应每周与 导师会面，就他们的研究撰写书面报告（实验研究或指定书籍/论文的研 究），并进行最后的公开演讲。导师将基于报告和演示文稿给学生评分。

B. Corresponding course at CUHK

Please give details of the closest corresponding course at CUHK (as approved by CUHK Senate and listed in course list). If the course in Shenzhen maps to more than one course at CUHK, please make multiple copies of the block below.

Course code	
Course title (English)	
Course title (Chinese)	
Units	
Description (English)	
Description (Chinese)	

2. Course requisites

Please state prerequisites and co-requisites, in terms of courses at CUHK-Shenzhen or any other requirements.

A. Prerequisites

DDA2081 Independent Study I ERG2081 Independent Study I

B. Co-requisites

C. Exclusion

D. Others

3. Learning outcomes

Students should be able to demonstrate thorough knowledge and understanding of the topics studied in the project; Furthermore, they should be able to apply their previously and newly acquired knowledge to explore novel ideas. Finally, students should be able to report their findings in an oral presentation and/or a written document.

4. Course syllabus

Please highlight fundamental concepts involved in each topic to help students better understand what is covered in the course.

N.A.

5. Assessment scheme

Component/ method	% weight
Reports	60
Presentation	40

Remarks:

6. Grade descriptor

The grade descriptor should align with specific course learning outcomes, not a generic description applicable to all courses.

Type:**General**

Grade	Description
A	Demonstrates the ability to achieve all the learning outcomes in this course and be able to follow all "Best-Practice" in accordance to "Assessment Scheme". Students shows outstanding performance that surpass the normal expectation at this level with exceptional skills in creativity and innovation, both in class and take-home assignments
A-	Mostly follow "Best-Practice" in accordance to "Assessment Scheme" with minor, non-critical errors found. Students demonstrates strong ability in understanding and applying all "Best-Practice" requirements in a clear and best manner
B	Generally follow "Good" requirements in accordance to "Assessment Scheme" with several non-critical errors. Students show strong ability in both "Best-Practice" & "Good" areas with setbacks and has the ability to apply the knowledge in a satisfactory and unambiguous manner
C	Generally follow "Good/Average" requirements with several errors including critical ones. Students show general understanding of the principles learnt in the course in a manner that is not incorrect but is somewhat fragmented.
D	Generally follow "Average/Poor" requirements with several errors including critical ones. Students show basic understanding of the principles learnt in the course in a manner that is broadly correct in its essential in some simple and familiar situations.
F	Unsatisfactory performance on a number of learning outcomes; OR failure to meet majority of assessment requirements.

7. Feedback for evaluation

Please specify forms of evaluation to generate feedback on classes from students.

- A course questionnaire answered by every student after finishing the course
- Reflections from teachers of more advanced courses
- Feedback from informal conversation and e-mail correspondence with students after class

8. Readings

Recommended:

Others:

9. Course components

Activity	Hours/week
Readings & Assignments	4

10. Indicative teaching plan

Week	Content/ topic/ activity
00000 00014	Each one is expected to meet with the supervisor regularly, either weekly or biweekly. The minimum number of contact hours with the supervisor for the entire semester is 10 hours.

11. Implementation plan

The implementation plan may vary from year to year. Please indicate expected enrolment, and number of sections. Example: 150 students for lecture (x 2); 30 students for tutorials (x 10).

12. Academic honesty and plagiarism

A course outline may include subject-specific requirements on plagiarism, in addition to the University established policies.

Students must complete all coursework and assessments independently, unless AI tool use is explicitly permitted. Unauthorized or improper use of AI may constitute academic dishonesty and harm learning. Misuse includes submitting AI-generated work as one's own, using AI to cheat, or employing AI unethically. Always obtain permission before using AI in academic work, and be sure to acknowledge any AI use in submissions.

13. Approval

Has the course title been included in the programme submission approved by CUHK Senate? Are there any differences? Have the details (as in this document) been approved at School or other level in CUHK- Shenzhen?

Submit application

14. Any other information

1. Open to all students from the Nobel class (including the freshman class) and all year 2-4 SDS students.

2. Minimum GPA requirement: 3.7 (except for the Nobel class and Bachelor-PhD class).
3. The coursework can be original study on a defined topic, doing a project, programming in support of a project, and/or any other learning experience at the appropriate level.
4. The current list of available supervisors can be checked at the School.
5. Registration is subject to the approval of faculty member who will act as the supervisor of the student for this class, and the Dean of the School.
6. Nobel Class student can repeatedly take Independent Study to earn credits for at most 3 times during the undergraduate study.
7. As this course is different from the course of capstone project, sophomore and junior non-Nobel students can repeatedly take Independent Study to earn credits for at most 2 times (4 credits) during the undergraduate study.

15. Version date

Version number	6
As of (date)	2025-11-04